CIVILS ATLAS / RESEARCH EDITION 19

January 2025

Understand the news.
Retain what matters.

85 study notes · 30 MCQs · Mains frameworks

UPSC × Andhra Pradesh APPSC · English
Research cut-off: 7 November 2026

Read the coverage contract

Not exhaustive. Expanded monthly volumes are selected research batches; the rest of the requested archive remains incomplete. No month has passed a complete daily source audit. Full-text and source-extract evidence are distinguished. Historical notes do not certify current law, implementation or latest statistics.

New notes separate reported facts from original static connections, analysis, cautions and Mains prompts. P1 = core; P2 = consolidation; P3 = selective factual recall. Broad AP relevance is not exact APPSC paper mapping. Read the research audit for omissions and unresolved claims.

Hosted push run observed; first scheduled execution remains unverified. Automation collects unreviewed source links, not researched study notes.

Source extracts are not whole-document reviews. November covers only 1–7 November. Review research/Research-Status.md before treating any month as complete.

Subject guide

Polity & Governance — 12 notes

Economy — 16 notes

Agriculture — 3 notes

Society & Welfare — 5 notes

Environment — 8 notes

Science & Technology — 6 notes

Security — 7 notes

International Relations — 11 notes

Andhra Pradesh — 11 notes

Culture & History — 2 notes

Awards & Sports — 4 notes

How to study

Read P1 → consolidate P2 → recall P3. Review after 1, 7 and 30 days. Explain each caution unaided. Build answers with a dated fact, mechanism, limitation and conclusion.

Sources and access provenance appear in the appendix. Original analysis is not a sourced prediction of exam questions.

Polity & Governance

01 · Local governance

SVAMITVA: January property-card distribution

CA-029 · P1 · 2025-01-18 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The 18 January distribution event highlighted rural residential-property records.

• The 18 January event distributed about 65 lakh property cards across more than 50,000 villages, according to the ministry review.

• The scheme uses drones and mapping to support rural residential-property records.

• January distribution and December preparation totals are separate snapshots and are not added together here.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A cadastral record can support certainty and transactions but does not by itself resolve every competing legal claim.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Property mapping may help formal credit and local planning where institutions recognise and maintain the record.

• Participatory objections, protection of vulnerable residents and affordable correction are essential.

PRELIMS CAUTION Abadi residential mapping is not redistribution of all agricultural land. Prepared and distributed cards differ; cards do not automatically settle every title dispute.

MAINS PROMPT Assess drone-based rural property mapping through credit access, dispute resolution and safeguards for excluded residents.

Sources: [PRI]

Evidence access: First-edition source check; independent full-text provenance not retained

02 · Development institutions

NITI Aayog at ten: advisory federalism

VM2501-002 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS NITI Aayog completed ten years from its 1 January 2015 establishment. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• It was established by a Union Cabinet resolution, replacing the Planning Commission.

• It is neither a constitutional body nor a statutory commission.

• The Prime Minister chairs it; its role includes policy advice, monitoring and cooperative/competitive federalism.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An advisory institution differs from the Finance Commission, whose constitutional mandate concerns fiscal recommendations.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Comparative indicators can facilitate learning if methods and limitations are transparent.

• AP should assess the diagnostic usefulness of rankings rather than treating advisory scoring as an automatic funding entitlement.

PRELIMS CAUTION NITI Aayog does not have the same constitutional status or transfer-allocation role as the Finance Commission.

MAINS PROMPT Discuss the value and limits of policy think tanks in cooperative federalism.

Sources: [V2501-02]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

04 · Digital rights & proportionality

Internet shutdowns: legality is not necessity

VM2501-003 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The edition reviewed shutdown trends and the updated telecommunications framework. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The Temporary Suspension of Services Rules, 2024 operate under the Telecommunications Act, 2023.

• Shutdowns affect communications, commerce, education and access to public services.

• Different trackers can use different definitions of an incident and duration.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Constitutional review examines authority, legitimate purpose, necessity, proportionality and procedural safeguards; access restrictions and speech restrictions overlap.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Reasoned orders, periodic review and narrow geographic/time scope can reduce unnecessary harms.

• Localised alternatives should be assessed before denying essential services to a whole population.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat a tracker’s count as a universally reconciled official total or assume statutory authority removes proportionality review.

MAINS PROMPT What safeguards should constrain temporary communications restrictions?

Sources: [V2501-04]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

05 · Parliament & constitutional practice

Budget Session and President’s Address

JAN25-001 · P1 · 2025-01-31 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget Session opened on 31 January; the President addressed both Houses and the Survey was tabled.

• The Economic Survey was tabled on 31 January; Budget presentation was scheduled for 1 February.

• PRS recorded 27 planned sitting days in two phases, with a recess.

• The speech outlined executive policy objectives; its promotional claims need outcome-based scrutiny.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Article 87 provides for the special address after a general election and at the first session of each year. This differs from Article 108’s joint sitting to resolve legislative deadlock.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Use the Address to identify promises for later audit rather than memorising every claimed achievement.

• The recess enables committee scrutiny of ministry demands; accountability depends on adequate time, evidence and follow-up.

PRELIMS CAUTION An address to both Houses is not an Article 108 joint sitting. The 2025–26 Budget belongs to February, not January.

MAINS PROMPT How can Parliament strengthen financial scrutiny even when the government has a stable majority?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

06 · Digital rights & identification

Draft Digital Personal Data Protection Rules 2025

JAN25-002 · P1 · 2025-01-03 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Draft rules sought to operationalise the DPDP Act, 2023; January was a consultation stage.

• The draft addressed notices, consent, children’s data and breach communication.

• PRS records a digital Data Protection Board and annual audit/impact-assessment duties for significant data fiduciaries.

• Verifiable parental consent was proposed, subject to specified exceptions.

• Comments were invited until 18 February 2025.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A data principal is the individual concerned; a data fiduciary determines purpose and means of processing. Privacy safeguards should be assessed through necessity, proportionality and remedies.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Consent is meaningful only if notices are understandable and withdrawal is usable.

• Child-protection checks can themselves collect sensitive identity data; design should minimise that trade-off.

• Enforcement capacity and institutional independence affect whether formal rights can actually be exercised.

PRELIMS CAUTION A draft is not final notified law. January’s version does not establish November 2026’s legal position. Do not import GDPR rights unless the Indian text provides them.

MAINS PROMPT How can India combine low-friction digital services with meaningful control over personal data?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

Entity Locker for organisational documents

JAN25-008 · P2 · 2025-01-20 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS MeitY described a business-document storage, sharing and verification platform.

• The National eGovernance Division developed Entity Locker.

• Features include government-database integration, consent-based sharing and role-based access.

• The release specified 10 GB encrypted storage and digital-signature support.

• Examples include vendor checks, corporate filings and MSME lending documents.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Digital trust requires authenticity, access control and correction. A document can be authentically signed yet contain outdated substantive information.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Reusable verification can lower repeated documentation costs in lending and procurement.

• Benefits depend on accurate registries, consent records, audit trails and mechanisms to correct wrong data.

PRELIMS CAUTION An organisational document wallet is not simply a renamed personal identity card. Platform availability does not prove every workflow is interoperable.

MAINS PROMPT How can document interoperability improve ease of doing business without weakening data protection?

Sources: [J-ENTITY]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Aadhaar authentication: wider application route

JAN25-003 · P1 · 2025-01-31 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Amendments widened the purposes and entities that could seek authentication permission.

• Ease of living and better service access were included as purposes.

• Non-government entities could submit proposals through the concerned department.

• Central authorisation involves UIDAI recommendations, as summarised by PRS.

• This was not automatic permission for every business to access Aadhaar data.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Authentication verifies identity information; it differs from storing biometrics, collecting a photocopy or determining citizenship.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Convenience gains should be paired with transparent, purpose-limited authorisation.

• Alternative verification and grievance channels matter when authentication fails because of connectivity, disability or record mismatch.

PRELIMS CAUTION Permission to apply is not blanket authorisation. Aadhaar is not citizenship proof and an authentication framework is not a universal mandate.

MAINS PROMPT Evaluate expanded authentication using convenience, privacy, exclusion and accountability as four tests.

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

07 · Equality, family law & courts

R.G. Kar case: conviction and sentencing

JAN25-065 · P1 · 2025-01-20 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The trial court sentenced Sanjay Roy after the 2024 crime against an on-duty doctor.

• Conviction was delivered on 18 January; sentence on 20 January.

• The Sealdah court imposed imprisonment for the remainder of natural life.

• The court declined the death penalty under the rarest-of-rare assessment.

• This is a trial-court snapshot; subsequent appeals require separate review.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Conviction determines guilt; sentencing determines punishment. Individualised sentencing and appellate review are parts of due process even in cases provoking widespread outrage.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Health-worker safety requires access control, safe rest areas, reporting systems and institutional responsibility—not only punishment after a crime.

• Assess workplace safety and gender justice alongside evidence-based prosecution and fair procedure.

PRELIMS CAUTION The victim must not be identified. A trial judgment is not proof that every later appeal or institutional-safety issue is resolved.

MAINS PROMPT Why should protection of women at work combine institutional prevention, accountability and fair criminal procedure?

Sources: [J-RGKAR]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Uttarakhand Uniform Civil Code: commencement

JAN25-004 · P1 · 2025-01-27 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The state’s UCC commenced on 27 January 2025.

• The notification brought the Uniform Civil Code, Uttarakhand, 2024 into force.

• Coverage includes marriage, divorce, maintenance and succession; reporting also highlights live-in registration.

• Scheduled Tribes and specified protected communities are excluded from the reported framework.

• This was state implementation, not a nationwide UCC.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Article 44 is a Directive Principle, not a directly enforceable Fundamental Right. Reform must also be examined against equality, religious freedom, privacy and legislative competence.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Gender-just succession and accessible remedies can be substantive benefits.

• Mandatory relationship registration separately raises privacy and proportionality questions.

• Uniform legal form alone cannot establish equal outcomes without legal aid and accessible procedures.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not erase Goa’s historical civil-law framework by claiming no earlier Indian precedent. Verify subsequent amendments and litigation for current-law answers.

MAINS PROMPT Can personal-law reform advance gender justice while protecting pluralism and privacy?

Sources: [J-UCC]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

PG medical admissions: residence reservation

JAN25-005 · P1 · 2025-01-29 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Supreme Court examined residence-based reservation in postgraduate medical courses.

• PRS reports residence-based reservation in PG medical education was held contrary to Article 14.

• State-quota seats were to follow NEET merit subject to the ruling’s distinctions.

• Reasonable institutional preference was distinguished from residence reservation.

• Existing completed admissions were protected, as summarised by PRS.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Equality permits reasonable classification with a rational nexus to the objective. Residence, domicile and institutional preference are not interchangeable.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• National specialist training supports merit and mobility, while local doctor shortages remain a genuine policy concern.

• Better infrastructure, service incentives and transparent obligations can address shortages without unjustified residence exclusion.

PRELIMS CAUTION The judgment did not abolish every reservation, every state quota or all institutional preference. Do not generalise the PG holding to all MBBS admissions.

MAINS PROMPT How should specialist medical education balance equal access and regional healthcare needs?

Sources: [J-PRS], [J-SC]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

08 · Legislative scrutiny

Waqf Bill: Joint Committee recommendations

JAN25-006 · P1 · 2025-01-30 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS January’s event was a committee report on the 2024 Bill, not enactment.

• The committee recommended prospective removal of waqf-by-user.

• It recommended an officer above collector rank for the government-property role described in the Bill.

• It recommended retaining a three-member tribunal including a Muslim-law expert.

• Parliamentary passage, assent and commencement were later stages.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A committee recommends amendments; its report is not binding law. Final enacted text may differ from both the original Bill and committee suggestions.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Digital records may improve administration, but disputed ownership needs notice, impartial adjudication and appeal.

• The episode illustrates the relationship between administrative reform, property rights, minority institutions and procedural fairness.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not backdate the later 2025 Act to January or assume every recommendation became law unchanged.

MAINS PROMPT Why is committee scrutiny especially important for legislation affecting property and minority institutions?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

10 · Regulatory administration

Cable operators: online national registration

JAN25-007 · P2 · 2025-01-17 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Cable Television Network Rules amendments changed the local-operator registration route.

• Registration moved from local head post offices to a ministry-led online process.

• Registration permitted operations throughout India, rather than a specified local area.

• The fee became ₹5,000 for five years, replacing ₹500 for one year.

• Renewal and appeal arrangements were provided.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Digitising a licence is not abolishing licensing. Registration reform does not automatically remove obligations imposed by other laws.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• A unified process can reduce repeated compliance and improve predictability.

• Small operators need assisted access, clear transition rules and usable appeals if the reform is to reduce rather than redistribute friction.

PRELIMS CAUTION Compare fee, validity and geographical scope together: a higher upfront fee is not the same as a tenfold annual cost increase.

MAINS PROMPT What indicators would show that online licensing genuinely reduced small-business compliance costs?

Sources: [J-PRS], [J-LCO]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

Economy

03 · Industry & MSMEs

Mutual Credit Guarantee Scheme for MSMEs

JAN25-015 · P1 · 2025-01-29 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS A guarantee mechanism aimed at equipment and machinery finance was approved.

• NCGTC was to provide 60% guarantee cover to eligible lenders.

• Eligible loans could be up to ₹100 crore per MSME.

• For loans up to ₹50 crore, PRS describes repayment up to eight years and principal moratorium up to two.

• The arrangement was time/aggregate-limit bound.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A guarantee shares specified lender risk; it is not a borrower grant or automatic sanction. The loan still needs viability appraisal.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Risk sharing can overcome collateral constraints and enable productive equipment upgrades.

• Due diligence and monitoring are essential to control moral hazard and contingent public liabilities.

• For AP clusters, actual access by viable smaller firms matters more than announcement totals.

PRELIMS CAUTION ₹100 crore is a loan ceiling and 60% is guarantee cover, not a ₹100 crore cash gift to every MSME.

MAINS PROMPT Assess guarantees as a tool for manufacturing-led MSME growth.

Sources: [J-PRS], [J-MSME]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

04 · Critical minerals

National Critical Mineral Mission

CA-013 · P1 · 2025-01-29 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet approved a seven-year critical-mineral mission on 29 January.

• Cabinet approved ₹16,300 crore expenditure with expected ₹18,000 crore investment by PSUs and others, totalling ₹34,300 crore over seven years.

• Value chain spans exploration, mining, beneficiation, processing and end-of-life recovery.

• Overseas assets, stockpiles, recycling and processing parks are included.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Resource security concerns the entire chain from exploration to processing and recycling, not merely owning a mineral deposit.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Processing technology and concentrated supply chains can remain bottlenecks even when domestic reserves exist.

• Diversified imports, domestic processing, recycling and environmental safeguards should reinforce one another.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS JAN25-037, E5-2506-010, E5-2507-041, E5-2508-015, E6-2509-018, E6-2510-015, E7-2511-009, E8-2601-014 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION ₹34,300 crore is not entirely direct government budgetary expenditure.

MAINS PROMPT Explain why processing capability and recycling matter as much as mineral ownership.

Sources: [NCMM]

Evidence access: First-edition source check; independent full-text provenance not retained

05 · External sector

Diamond Imprest Authorisation

JAN25-016 · P2 · 2025-01-21 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS A new input-access mechanism sought to support diamond-processing exports.

• Eligible exporters could import natural cut/polished diamonds below one-quarter carat duty-free.

• Export-performance and compliance conditions applied.

• The framework required at least 10% value addition.

• The announced implementation date was 1 April 2025.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Duty-free input authorisation differs from an unrestricted import exemption. Input access can preserve processing competitiveness and jobs.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The economic objective is retaining domestic value addition amid volatile global demand.

• Traceability, customs scrutiny and export verification are needed to prevent round-tripping and misuse.

PRELIMS CAUTION The announcement was not an immediate general subsidy for every gemstone or all lab-grown diamonds.

MAINS PROMPT Why might a domestic processing industry need imported inputs, and how should exemptions be safeguarded?

Sources: [J-PRS], [J-DIA]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

06 · Consumption data & inequality

HCES 2023–24: consumption is not income

VM2501-005 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The January issue interpreted results from the household consumption survey. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The survey reference period was August 2023–July 2024.

• Reported MPCE excluding imputation was ₹4,122 rural and ₹6,996 urban.

• Figures including imputed benefits differ and must not be mixed with the excluding-imputation series.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL MPCE measures consumption expenditure per person per month. A consumption Gini is not automatically an income or wealth Gini.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Changing food/non-food shares inform welfare and price-index discussions, but nominal growth is not identical to improved real purchasing power.

• National averages can obscure inter-state and social-group differences relevant to AP policy.

PRELIMS CAUTION The publication/issue month is not the survey period. The magazine’s wording linking a consumption Gini directly to income inequality needs qualification.

MAINS PROMPT How should household consumption data be used without overstating what it measures?

Sources: [V2501-21]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

06 · Exchange rates & external payments

Rupee depreciation and internationalisation are different questions

VM2501-004 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue examined exchange-rate pressures alongside RBI measures supporting rupee settlement. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Depreciation means a currency loses value relative to another; a higher INR/USD quote means more rupees per dollar.

• Rupee internationalisation concerns its use for cross-border pricing, settlement and financial claims.

• Permitted rupee-account and settlement arrangements operate within FEMA rules and bank compliance.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A Vostro account is the foreign bank’s account from the domestic bank’s perspective; the corresponding Nostro is viewed from the account-owning bank’s perspective.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Currency weakness can raise imported-input costs even where some exporters gain on conversion.

• Settlement in rupees can reduce some conversion exposure but requires willing counterparties, liquidity and usable balances.

PRELIMS CAUTION International settlement facilities do not establish full capital-account convertibility or eliminate exchange-rate risk.

MAINS PROMPT Can wider rupee settlement strengthen resilience without replacing macroeconomic stability?

Sources: [V2501-17], [V2501-18]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

06 · Growth, inflation & statistics

GDP first advance estimate: FY2024–25

JAN25-009 · P1 · 2025-01-07 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS January's NSO release estimated the year before complete data were available.

• Real GDP growth was estimated at 6.4% for FY2024–25.

• The same vintage reported 8.2% for FY2023–24.

• PRS reproduced agriculture GVA growth of 3.8%, manufacturing 5.3% and construction 8.6%.

• These were constant-2011–12-price growth estimates.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL GDP at market prices differs from GVA by product taxes less product subsidies. Advance estimates are revised as fuller evidence arrives.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The pattern shows uneven sectoral growth; a single aggregate does not describe every livelihood.

• Use the contemporary estimate to explain January policy concerns, but the latest official series for a present-day statistical answer.

• Deceleration is slower growth, not necessarily output contraction.

PRELIMS CAUTION 6.4% is a January estimate, not an immutable final number. Do not silently combine it with later revised or rebased series.

MAINS PROMPT Why are advance GDP estimates useful despite revision risk?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

Inflation: Q3 FY2024–25 food-price pressure

JAN25-011 · P1 · 2025-01-14 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS January releases enabled a review of October–December price trends.

• PRS computed Q3 CPI inflation at 5.6%, compared with 4.2% in Q2.

• Food inflation averaged 9.4% in Q3; WPI averaged 2.3%.

• The Survey's April–December CPI average was 4.9% and food average 8.4%.

• These refer to different periods, not contradictory readings of the same indicator.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL CPI and WPI have different baskets, weights and coverage. Disinflation means slower price increase; deflation means a falling price level.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Food supply shocks can persist even when other prices moderate.

• Interest rates can influence demand and expectations, while storage, logistics and climate resilience address supply bottlenecks.

PRELIMS CAUTION A quarterly average is not December's monthly rate. Lower inflation does not mean all prices returned to earlier levels.

MAINS PROMPT Why does food inflation need a response beyond interest-rate policy?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

Economic Survey 2024–25: outlook and deregulation

JAN25-010 · P1 · 2025-01-31 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Survey set the analytical context immediately before the Budget.

• The Survey projected real FY2025–26 growth of 6.3–6.8%.

• It argued for around 8% sustained growth over at least a decade to advance developed-country ambitions.

• It highlighted investment, confidence, rural demand and wages.

• Deregulation priorities included land, labour, transport and logistics, especially for smaller firms.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The Survey is an analytical government document, not spending authorisation or a Finance Act. A forecast range is not a guaranteed outcome.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Fixed compliance costs disproportionately burden small firms; predictable risk-based rules can enable scaling.

• Smart deregulation removes unnecessary friction while retaining worker, environmental and consumer protections.

• AP application: industrial permissions and port-linked logistics need measurable process improvements.

PRELIMS CAUTION Budget tax slabs announced in February are not January Survey provisions.

MAINS PROMPT What would smart deregulation mean for a state seeking investment and employment?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

07 · Pay & fiscal management

Eighth Central Pay Commission: approval

JAN25-012 · P2 · 2025-01-16 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet approved constitution of the next Central Pay Commission.

• The approval concerned the Eighth Central Pay Commission.

• It concerns central-government pay and pension-related review.

• PRS linked the timing to the Seventh Commission period approaching its 2026 endpoint.

• January did not establish final pay scales or a final fitment factor.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A pay commission recommends; the government decides acceptance, financing and effective dates. States may face separate fiscal and political pressures.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Pay revision may support consumption and retention but also creates permanent spending commitments.

• Evaluate fairness, fiscal cost and service-delivery results rather than only the headline wage increase.

PRELIMS CAUTION Approval to constitute is not implementation. Claims of a confirmed doubled salary or final fitment factor go beyond January evidence.

MAINS PROMPT How can public pay reform balance employee welfare and fiscal sustainability?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

08 · Financial inclusion & markets

Social Stock Exchange: wider-access proposals

JAN25-014 · P2 · 2025-01-20 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS SEBI reviewed permissible legal structures and activities for social enterprises.

• The proposals widened eligible not-for-profit structures.

• Suggested activities included disadvantaged-child welfare, vocational skills and scientific research.

• PRS records a proposed time limit on registration without fundraising.

• The framework remained at consultation stage in January.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A Social Stock Exchange provides a regulated fundraising framework. Registration is not automatic proof of independently verified social impact.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Formal fundraising can diversify social-sector finance.

• Impact reporting, audit quality and beneficiary accountability are needed to prevent mission-washing and unsuitable claims.

PRELIMS CAUTION Not every instrument is an ordinary tradable equity share paying dividends. Do not present consultation changes as already implemented.

MAINS PROMPT How can social finance combine wider access to funds with credible outcome measurement?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

SEBI’s ₹250 small-ticket SIP proposal

JAN25-013 · P2 · 2025-01-22 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The regulator consulted on lower-entry-ticket mutual-fund investment.

• The proposal envisaged ₹250 periodic investments.

• Discounted processing arrangements were contemplated for up to three such plans per investor.

• The objective was broader participation among underserved investors.

• This was a consultation, not proof of universal product launch.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An SIP is a contribution method, not a guaranteed-return asset. Mutual-fund risk depends on the underlying portfolio.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Low tickets reduce entry friction but do not substitute for suitability, clear disclosure or grievance access.

• Households also need liquid emergency buffers; market-linked investment is not a substitute for every form of safe saving.

PRELIMS CAUTION ₹250 is not a government cash benefit or guaranteed monthly return. A proposal is not a final universally applicable rule.

MAINS PROMPT What safeguards should accompany efforts to promote market-linked financial inclusion?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

09 · Logistics & manufacturing

LEADS 2024: AP a coastal Fast Mover

JAN25-017 · P1 · 2025-01-03 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The sixth LEADS report was released in January despite its 2024 edition name.

• The pillars were infrastructure, services, operating/regulatory environment and sustainable logistics.

• States/UTs were assessed in coastal, landlocked, northeastern and UT groups.

• AP and Goa were coastal Fast Movers.

• Gujarat, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Odisha and Tamil Nadu were coastal Achievers.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL LEADS benchmarks subnational logistics; the World Bank’s Logistics Performance Index compares countries. Category labels do not automatically establish an exact national numerical rank.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP’s port advantage depends on dependable road/rail evacuation and competitive last-mile links.

• The sustainable-logistics lens adds modal efficiency, emissions and resilient infrastructure to capacity expansion.

PRELIMS CAUTION AP was not a coastal Achiever in this edition. Report year and release year differ.

MAINS PROMPT How can AP turn its coastline into lower logistics costs and wider industrial development?

Sources: [J-LEADS]

Evidence access: Full substantive PIB text read

White-goods PLI: third selection round

JAN25-018 · P2 · 2025-01-20 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The round targeted components for ACs and LED lights.

• The release recorded 24 beneficiaries with ₹3,516 crore investment commitments.

• Eighteen new firms committed ₹2,299 crore and six existing beneficiaries an additional ₹1,217 crore.

• AC commitments were ₹3,260 crore; LED commitments ₹256 crore.

• The aim included domestic component capability and value addition.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Production-linked support is conditional. Committed investment, realised investment, commissioned capacity and incentive disbursal are different measures.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Component depth can create stronger supplier capability than final assembly alone.

• Measure additional output/exports, supplier development, jobs and subsidy cost to assess whether the support changed behaviour.

PRELIMS CAUTION Committed investment is not already spent capital. This round was not the original scheme launch.

MAINS PROMPT What distinguishes an effective manufacturing incentive from subsidy for production that would have occurred anyway?

Sources: [J-PLI]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

10 · Digital economy measurement

Measuring the digital economy beyond the IT sector

VM2501-006 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed MeitY’s commissioned measurement study. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The study was undertaken by ICRIER.

• It draws on OECD/ADB measurement approaches.

• The coverage includes digitally enabled portions of traditional industries, not just hardware and software firms.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A sector’s digitally enabled value added, platform turnover and the entire sector’s GDP contribution are different aggregates.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Comparable measurement can inform infrastructure, skills and inclusion policy.

• Assess digital adoption alongside productivity, cybersecurity, access and distribution of gains rather than assuming all digitisation creates equal welfare.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not add overlapping ICT and digitally enabled sector estimates or confuse a forecast with measured current output.

MAINS PROMPT Why does digital-economy measurement require careful boundaries?

Sources: [V2501-23]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

10 · Employment & skills reports

Future of Jobs Report 2025

JAN25-044 · P1 · 2025-01-08 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS WEF assessed employer expectations for labour-market change through 2030.

• Projected global roles created: 170 million; displaced: 92 million; net gain: 78 million.

• The evidence drew on more than 1,000 employers across 22 industries and 55 economies.

• Large skill shifts and reskilling needs were highlighted.

• Growth includes technology roles as well as frontline, care and education work.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An employer-survey projection is not an official census or guarantee. Net job gains can coexist with severe losses in specific occupations.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Policy needs portable skills, apprenticeships and transition support rather than assuming gains reach every displaced worker.

• AP skilling should be assessed through demand evidence, completion, placement quality and retention.

PRELIMS CAUTION The figures are global projections, not Indian jobs already created. The indexed day follows the dated press text; source metadata differs by a day.

MAINS PROMPT Why can aggregate job growth coexist with individual worker insecurity?

Sources: [J-JOBS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

12 · Cooperatives & institutional governance

International Year of Cooperatives: governance before scale

VM2501-001 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The edition examined the 2025 international observance and cooperative institutions. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The 2025 theme is Cooperatives Build a Better World.

• Cooperatives organise member ownership and mutual economic benefit rather than shareholder return alone.

• Indian cooperative governance includes state and multi-state legal frameworks.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Article 19(1)(c), Article 43B and the constitutional litigation over Part IXB must be read together; do not assume every Part IXB provision applies unchanged to state societies.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Member participation, professional management and independent audits determine whether scale serves members.

• AP dairy, credit and producer organisations need transparent elections and conflict controls, not simply more registrations.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2507-013, E5-2507-014, E9-2602-017, E9-2602-018, E9-2602-030, E9-2602-031, E9-2602-033, E10-2603-021 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION The international-year designation does not mean the observance was first launched in January; the global launch predates 2025. Do not reproduce unverified cooperative-share statistics.

MAINS PROMPT How can cooperative autonomy coexist with professional accountability?

Sources: [V2501-01]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

Agriculture

03 · Insurance & risk management

Crop insurance continuation and FIAT

JAN25-019 · P1 · 2025-01-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS PMFBY and RWBCIS were continued through FY2025–26.

• The overall FY2021–22 to FY2025–26 outlay was ₹69,515.71 crore.

• The Fund for Innovation and Technology was ₹824.77 crore.

• YES-TECH supports technology-based yield estimation; WINDS supports hyperlocal weather data.

• The package supports better assessment and claims administration.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL PMFBY principally insures yield loss; RWBCIS uses weather triggers as proxies. A farmer’s loss may differ from the index-triggered payout: this is basis risk.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Technology can reduce delay only if data and ground validation are reliable.

• Tenant documentation, assisted enrolment and timely settlement remain important for AP’s cyclone- and flood-exposed agriculture.

• Weather-station density and maintenance affect the quality of index products.

PRELIMS CAUTION The ₹69,515.71 crore figure is not a one-year FY2025–26 allocation. Weather insurance does not directly measure every field’s actual loss.

MAINS PROMPT How can crop insurance reduce vulnerability without creating new data and exclusion problems?

Sources: [J-CROP]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

04 · Inputs & fertilisers

DAP special package extended

JAN25-020 · P1 · 2025-01-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Additional DAP support was extended through calendar 2025.

• The extension covered 1 January–31 December 2025.

• The tentative budget requirement was ₹3,850 crore.

• The package operated alongside Nutrient Based Subsidy.

• Support was linked to actual point-of-sale DAP transactions in the covered period.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL DAP is a phosphatic fertiliser. P&K nutrient-based support differs from urea’s pricing arrangements; relative prices can affect nutrient balance.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Price support shields farmers from external input shocks but may reinforce imbalanced application if relative incentives are distorted.

• A durable approach combines affordability, soil testing, reliable supply and efficient use.

PRELIMS CAUTION Calendar-year coverage is not the same as the financial year ending March 2026. Do not assume all fertilisers share identical pricing rules.

MAINS PROMPT Assess fertiliser support through affordability, soil health and import dependence.

Sources: [J-CROP]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

05 · High-value crops & institutions

National Turmeric Board inaugurated

JAN25-021 · P1 · 2025-01-14 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Board’s launch highlighted value addition and market development.

• Inauguration took place in New Delhi on 14 January.

• Headquarters was designated at Nizamabad, Telangana; Palle Ganga Reddy was first chairperson.

• Functions include research, quality standards, logistics, value addition and export promotion.

• The release explicitly highlighted production potential in AP and Telangana.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An inauguration venue, headquarters and beneficiary geography are separate facts. Commodity coordination must link research, producers and markets.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Farmer gains require processing, credible testing, traceability and bargaining power—not only a new institution.

• AP producer groups can pursue differentiated products and reliable export quality while avoiding unsubstantiated medicinal claims.

PRELIMS CAUTION The headquarters is not New Delhi or AP merely because those places feature in the event/policy. The Board is not an AP-only institution.

MAINS PROMPT How can a commodity board raise farmer incomes rather than merely add an administrative layer?

Sources: [J-TURMERIC]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Society & Welfare

01 · Public health

HMPV: routine surveillance without alarmism

JAN25-023 · P1 · 2025-01-06 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Two Karnataka infant detections prompted public-health clarification.

• The ministry described the cases as routine respiratory-pathogen surveillance detections.

• Neither child had an international travel history in the release.

• HMPV was already circulating globally, including India.

• The ministry reported no unusual national ILI/SARI surge at that time.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Detection is not proof of a novel pathogen, new importation chain or national epidemic. Surveillance findings must be interpreted with denominators and severity.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Communication should separate what is known, what is monitored and when advice changes.

• Clinical readiness and sentinel surveillance can improve without stigmatising patients or encouraging panic.

PRELIMS CAUTION January’s no-unusual-surge statement is date-specific, not a guarantee for all later months. HMPV did not first originate in India in January.

MAINS PROMPT How should agencies communicate infectious-disease findings responsibly?

Sources: [J-HMPV]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

GBS cluster in Pune: epidemiological investigation

JAN25-024 · P1 · 2025-01-31 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS WHO supported teams responding to suspected and confirmed Guillain-Barré Syndrome cases.

• WHO described active case search, spot mapping and epidemic-curve analysis.

• GBS involves an abnormal immune response affecting peripheral nerves.

• Safe water, food hygiene and hand hygiene were emphasised.

• Acute treatment can include plasma exchange or IV immunoglobulin, with rehabilitation as needed.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An autoimmune syndrome is not a single directly contagious pathogen. A preceding infection can trigger nerve injury; association is not proof of a common cause for every case.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Response needs clinical reporting, laboratory support, environmental investigation and critical-care capacity.

• Epidemiological methods are more durable exam learning than rapidly changing case totals.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call GBS a newly discovered contagious virus or assert an early suspected cause as proven for the entire cluster.

MAINS PROMPT What does a rare neurological cluster reveal about urban public-health preparedness?

Sources: [J-GBS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

03 · Education evidence & learning

ASER 2024: rural learning recovery

JAN25-022 · P1 · 2025-01-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The rural household survey measured foundational learning, not only school enrolment.

• ASER 2024 covered 649,491 children across 605 rural districts, according to reported findings.

• Government-school Standard III reading of Standard II text improved from 16.3% in 2022 to 23.4% in 2024.

• The all-school Standard III subtraction figure reported was 33.7%.

• The report was released on 28 January 2025.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL ASER is a non-government household survey; UDISE+ is an administrative school-data system. Methods, populations and indicators differ.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Recovery is encouraging but the low absolute reading benchmark still signals a major learning deficit.

• Teaching at actual learning level, regular low-stakes assessment and teacher support are key policy links.

• Use AP-specific tables before asserting an AP rank or precise state result.

PRELIMS CAUTION Government-school-only percentages cannot be substituted for all-school figures. Rural findings do not automatically describe every urban child.

MAINS PROMPT Why should learning outcomes be assessed separately from access and school infrastructure?

Sources: [J-ASER], [J-ASER2]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

04 · Higher education regulation

Draft UGC appointment regulations

JAN25-064 · P1 · 2025-01-06 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS UGC proposed changes to qualifications and university appointment processes.

• VC eligibility proposals included senior industry, public-policy and administrative experience of at least ten years with scholarly credentials.

• Search committees included nominees of the chancellor, UGC and institution’s apex body as described by PRS.

• The draft proposed removing the 10% cap on contractual teachers.

• Feedback was invited on the draft.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL University autonomy, standards and federal relations intersect in higher-education regulation. Appointment eligibility is not the same as a completed appointment.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Wider eligibility can introduce experience but needs transparent criteria and academic credibility.

• Contract flexibility should be evaluated alongside teaching quality, research independence and job security.

PRELIMS CAUTION January’s draft is not proof that every provision was final law or accepted by all states.

MAINS PROMPT How can university appointment systems combine autonomy, accountability and academic excellence?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

06 · Wealth, power & inequality

Oxfam’s Takers Not Makers: interpreting inequality claims

VM2501-009 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue examined the advocacy organisation’s wealth-inequality report. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The report is titled Takers Not Makers: The Unjust Poverty and Unearned Wealth of Colonial Inheritance.

• It discusses wealth concentration, inheritance, monopoly power and colonial legacies.

• It is an Oxfam analysis, not an Indian official household income survey.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Wealth is a stock, income is a flow and consumption is another distributional measure. PPP poverty lines require a stated base and reference year.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Analyse methods and assumptions before using striking global wealth claims as universal facts.

• Public finance, competition policy and broad access to capabilities address different mechanisms of inequality.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat advocacy estimates as court findings about every billionaire or use an undated PPP poverty threshold as permanently current.

MAINS PROMPT How should policymakers distinguish different mechanisms underlying economic inequality?

Sources: [V2501-37]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

Environment

01 · Forests & biodiversity

International Big Cat Alliance framework

CA-025 · P2 · 2025-01-23 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The IBCA framework entered into force on 23 January.

• IBCA framework entered into force on 23 January 2025; PIB reported this on 3 February.

• The five ratifying countries identified were India, Nicaragua, Eswatini, Somalia and Liberia.

• The seven target cats are tiger, lion, leopard, snow leopard, cheetah, jaguar and puma.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Big-cat cooperation links species knowledge with habitat, prey and landscape protection.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Cross-country research and finance can strengthen conservation, but local land-use and human-wildlife conflict still determine outcomes.

• Membership interest, ratification and operational programmes should be tracked separately.

PRELIMS CAUTION Launch, willingness to join, ratification and entry into force are distinct. Countries expressing interest are not automatically all ratifying members.

MAINS PROMPT Assess species-focused international cooperation through science, funding and habitat protection.

Sources: [J-IBCA]

Evidence access: First-edition source check; independent full-text provenance not retained

02 · Groundwater & public health

Groundwater quality: quantity security is insufficient

VM2501-007 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The magazine examined CGWB’s 2024 assessment. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The Central Ground Water Board conducts groundwater assessment and monitoring.

• Chemical contamination can involve nitrate, fluoride, arsenic or salinity with different local causes.

• Extraction/recharge classification and chemical water quality answer different questions.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Aquifer storage, recharge, extraction stage and drinking-water safety must be assessed separately.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• A state-level safe extraction category does not establish that every village has safe drinking water.

• AP requires local sampling, contamination-source control and treatment matched to the pollutant, alongside aquifer management.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not equate sustainable extraction with potable water or assume a statewide average describes each assessment unit.

MAINS PROMPT How can groundwater policy integrate quantity management with public-health protection?

Sources: [V2501-31]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

02 · Wetlands

Four Ramsar additions: January-end tally 89

JAN25-035 · P1 · 2025-01-31 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The announcement preceded World Wetlands Day; newspaper publication followed in February.

• Additions were Sakkarakottai and Therthangal in Tamil Nadu, Khecheopalri in Sikkim and Udhwa Lake in Jharkhand.

• The contemporary total became 89.

• Tamil Nadu’s count became 20.

• This records the January-end announcement, not a current total.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Ramsar recognises Wetlands of International Importance and wise use. It is not automatically national-park status or a prohibition on all livelihoods.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Effective conservation needs catchment and seasonal-hydrology management, not only a mapped boundary.

• Use the four additions for state–site matching and distinguish this recognition from wetland-city accreditation.

PRELIMS CAUTION 89 is not a November 2026 count. A Ramsar site and an accredited wetland city are different categories.

MAINS PROMPT Why can a wetland degrade despite international recognition?

Sources: [J-RAMSAR]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Indore and Udaipur: Ramsar Wetland Cities

CA-023 · P2 · 2025-01 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Indore and Udaipur received India’s first Wetland City Accreditations in January.

• The year-end review identifies Indore and Udaipur as India’s first Ramsar Wetland Cities in January 2025.

• Exact announcement day is not established here; the date is month-end indexing only.

• Indore is in Madhya Pradesh and Udaipur is in Rajasthan; accreditation of a city differs from Ramsar listing of a specific wetland.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Accreditation recognises urban wetland stewardship; it differs from listing an individual wetland as internationally important.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Urban wetlands can reduce flooding and support water quality when catchments and inflows are protected.

• Recognition must translate into land-use enforcement, sewage control and local stewardship.

PRELIMS CAUTION Wetland City Accreditation is not the same as declaring the entire city a Ramsar site.

MAINS PROMPT Discuss urban wetlands as flood buffers, biodiversity habitats and water-quality infrastructure.

Sources: [ENV]

Evidence access: First-edition source check; independent full-text provenance not retained

05 · Weather, climate & disasters

WMO: 2024 was the warmest year

JAN25-034 · P1 · 2025-01-10 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The multi-dataset assessment put one calendar year above the 1.5°C marker.

• UN/WMO reporting estimated 1.55°C above the pre-industrial baseline.

• Six international datasets underpinned the assessment.

• Individual dataset values differed.

• Warm land/ocean conditions and ocean heat were central concerns.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The Paris long-term temperature goal is not evaluated from one calendar-year anomaly alone. Baseline and methodology affect exact figures.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• A single-year exceedance is an urgent warning, not a reason to abandon mitigation.

• Adaptation addresses existing exposure; future emissions reduction shapes longer-run risk.

PRELIMS CAUTION An annual 1.55°C anomaly is not identical to a permanently established long-term Paris threshold breach. Always state the baseline.

MAINS PROMPT Why should temperature records strengthen both mitigation and adaptation?

Sources: [J-WARM]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Mission Mausam and IMD at 150

JAN25-033 · P1 · 2025-01-14 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The launch coincided with IMD’s 150th anniversary.

• Mission Mausam was launched on 14 January.

• The objective was a weather-ready, climate-smart India.

• Tools include advanced observations, radars/satellites and high-performance computing.

• IMD Vision 2047 was also released.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Weather forecasts concern short-term conditions; climate concerns longer-term patterns. Warnings save lives when they reach users in actionable form.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• For AP, cyclone, rainfall, heat and coastal warnings need district-level communication and drills.

• Assess lead time, reliability, user uptake and losses avoided—not only equipment spending.

PRELIMS CAUTION Better prediction does not mean every event can be exactly forecast or prevented. Uncertainty should be communicated.

MAINS PROMPT How can stronger weather science translate into fewer deaths in a coastal state?

Sources: [J-MAUSAM]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

06 · Circular economy & resources

End-of-Life Vehicles Rules 2025

JAN25-036 · P1 · 2025-01 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS January notification established a vehicle-waste EPR framework.

• Commencement was scheduled for 1 April 2025.

• PRS describes producer, owner, bulk-consumer and registered-scrapping-facility roles.

• Producer obligations include prescribed scrapping targets.

• The review records an agricultural-vehicle exclusion and differentiated pollution-board enforcement roles.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL EPR extends responsibility into the post-consumer lifecycle. Authorised dismantling can recover materials while reducing hazardous handling.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Traceable records and viable authorised facilities are necessary to prevent activity remaining informal.

• Convenient owner access and worker-transition measures complement environmental safeguards.

PRELIMS CAUTION Notification is not commencement. These rules are not a blanket January ban on every vehicle above a particular age.

MAINS PROMPT What makes an EPR system credible in practice?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

Offshore mineral conservation and development rules

JAN25-037 · P2 · 2025-01 (month-level index) · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS PRS covered operational safeguards in the offshore minerals framework.

• Exploration/production plans are required for the respective stages.

• The Indian Bureau of Mines has a plan-approval role.

• Safeguards address sedimentation, untreated waste, marine ecology and archaeological objects.

• PRS records a one-nautical-mile restriction from the low-tide line for mining/waste disposal under these rules.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Exploration rights, environmental compliance and production permission are distinct. Different coastal/offshore legal boundaries must not be casually interchanged.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Resource-security benefits must be weighed against ecological uncertainty and monitoring constraints.

• AP coastal relevance does not establish that any particular AP block has received clearance or begun production.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS CA-013, E5-2506-010, E5-2507-041, E5-2508-015, E6-2509-018, E6-2510-015, E7-2511-009, E8-2601-014 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION The rules have 2024 in their title while appearing in the January review. Do not infer unrestricted offshore mining.

MAINS PROMPT How should mineral security be balanced against precaution in marine ecosystems?

Sources: [J-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

Science & Technology

01 · Space

SpaDeX: docking milestone

CA-014 · P1 · 2025-01-16 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS ISRO demonstrated satellite docking on 16 January after a December 2024 launch.

• ISRO’s two SpaDeX satellites docked on 16 January 2025.

• The mission demonstrated rendezvous, docking and post-docking control capabilities.

• The demonstration followed the PSLV-C60 launch of the two satellites on 30 December 2024.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Rendezvous approaches two spacecraft; docking creates a controlled mechanical connection. This enables multi-launch architectures.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Docking is an enabling technology for orbital infrastructure and future multi-module missions.

• A demonstration is an important step, not proof that every human-spaceflight or lunar mission has already been accomplished.

PRELIMS CAUTION Mission launch was in December 2024; the docking milestone falls within this archive’s period.

MAINS PROMPT Explain relevance to multi-launch missions, orbital infrastructure and future human spaceflight.

Sources: [SPACE]

Evidence access: First-edition source check; independent full-text provenance not retained

Third Launch Pad at Sriharikota approved

JAN25-026 · P1 · 2025-01-16 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet approved new adaptable ground infrastructure in AP.

• The approved cost was ₹3,984.86 crore including associated facilities.

• The pad is designed for NGLV, with adaptability for LVM3 semi-cryogenic and scaled configurations.

• It provides standby capability for the Second Launch Pad.

• The stated establishment target was 48 months.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A pad is ground infrastructure, not a launch vehicle. Vehicle development, pad compatibility and mission qualification are separate tasks.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Redundancy and adaptability can ease scheduling constraints and support heavier missions.

• AP opportunities include precision suppliers and technical skills, but speculative job claims should not be treated as realised outcomes.

PRELIMS CAUTION Approval is not construction completion or operational readiness. Sriharikota is in AP, not Tamil Nadu.

MAINS PROMPT Why is adaptable ground infrastructure strategically important to a space programme?

Sources: [J-TLP]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

NVS-02: launcher success, spacecraft setback

JAN25-027 · P1 · 2025-01-29 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS GSLV-F15 placed NVS-02 into its intended transfer orbit on Sriharikota’s 100th launch.

• The mission was the 100th launch from Sriharikota and 17th GSLV launch.

• ISRO confirmed injection into the intended GTO.

• A later ISRO update reported that orbit raising could not proceed because oxidiser-admission valves did not open.

• Launcher injection and spacecraft orbit acquisition therefore had different outcomes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL NavIC provides positioning, navigation and timing. GTO is not the final operational orbit; successful injection is not complete satellite commissioning.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Navigation autonomy needs reliable spacecraft and constellation management as well as launch capability.

• Separate launcher success, final orbit, payload commissioning and operational service when reading mission reports.

PRELIMS CAUTION This was not ISRO’s 100th satellite. Do not claim NVS-02 reached its designated operational slot solely from launch success.

MAINS PROMPT How can a mission have a successful launch but still suffer a major post-launch failure?

Sources: [J-NVS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

04 · Biotechnology & data

GenomeIndia dataset: access and representation

JAN25-025 · P1 · 2025-01-09 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The January event opened research access through Indian data infrastructure.

• The January headline concerned about 10,000 sequenced Indian genomes and the Indian Biological Data Centre.

• A March parliamentary clarification specifies 10,074 healthy individuals from 83 populations sampled at 99 sites.

• The objective includes understanding genetic variation and supporting health research.

• The later clarification is retained to distinguish populations from sampling sites.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A reference dataset is not a diagnosis for every citizen. A genetic association is not necessarily a deterministic cause of disease.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• An Indian dataset can reduce global under-representation and support better diagnostics.

• Managed access, consent, re-identification safeguards and protection against discriminatory use are vital.

• Representative evidence and equitable access to resulting therapies determine the public benefit.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not conflate 99 sites with 99 populations or claim every Indian community is exhaustively covered.

MAINS PROMPT How can genomic research support equitable healthcare while protecting sensitive biological information?

Sources: [J-GENOME], [J-GENOME2]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

06 · Standards & measurement

Draft Indian Standard Time Rules

JAN25-028 · P2 · 2025-01-27 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Consumer Affairs proposed uniform legal and commercial time references.

• The draft sought IST as standard reference for official/commercial activity.

• Scientific, astronomical and navigation exceptions were addressed.

• The associated dissemination effort targeted high-precision synchronisation.

• January’s action was a draft consultation.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL IST is UTC+5:30. Legal time, atomic reference standards, network synchronisation and a local clock display are related but different.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Trusted timing supports financial audit trails, telecom, navigation and cyber investigation.

• Resilient implementation needs legacy-equipment planning and protection against timing-signal disruption.

PRELIMS CAUTION The proposal did not change the UTC offset or create multiple Indian time zones. A draft is not a final universal obligation.

MAINS PROMPT Why is trusted time synchronisation critical digital infrastructure?

Sources: [J-PRS], [J-IST]

Evidence access: Full PRS monthly synthesis read; linked primary references may remain unopened

07 · Scientific administration

V. Narayanan assumes ISRO leadership

JAN25-062 · P3 · 2025-01-13 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS ISRO recorded assumption of charge on the afternoon of 13 January.

• Roles included Secretary, Department of Space; Chairman, Space Commission; and Chairman, ISRO.

• He succeeded S. Somanath.

• His background includes liquid propulsion and LPSC leadership.

• The appointment announcement and assumption-of-charge date are separate facts.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL ISRO, DoS and the Space Commission have distinct institutional identities even when senior roles are held together.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Use primary appointment notices for the operative date.

• A dated historical appointment does not automatically certify the incumbent at every later date.

PRELIMS CAUTION The 15 January Bengaluru office visit was not the first assumption-of-charge date.

MAINS PROMPT Match the predecessor and three roles associated with the January transition.

Sources: [J-VN]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Security

01 · Defence & strategy

INS Surat, Nilgiri and Vaghsheer commissioned

JAN25-030 · P1 · 2025-01-15 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS A destroyer, frigate and submarine were commissioned together at Mumbai.

• Surat is the fourth/final P15B guided-missile destroyer.

• Nilgiri is the first P17A stealth frigate.

• Vaghsheer is the sixth/final P75 Scorpene-class submarine.

• The commissioning date was 15 January 2025.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Destroyers, frigates and submarines differ in role and operating characteristics. Indigenous construction may coexist with foreign technology cooperation.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Fleet renewal demonstrates shipbuilding capability and industrial learning.

• Readiness also needs trained crews, sensors, weapons, maintenance and logistics; induction alone is not the complete capability.

PRELIMS CAUTION Vaghsheer is not nuclear-powered. P75 is not P75(I); Nilgiri is not a P15B destroyer.

MAINS PROMPT How does naval construction support security and a wider industrial ecosystem?

Sources: [J-NAVY]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

03 · Policing & transnational crime

BHARATPOL: international police assistance

JAN25-029 · P1 · 2025-01-07 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS CBI’s portal sought to streamline agency access to international cooperation.

• The portal was developed by CBI and launched on 7 January.

• It supports information sharing and INTERPOL assistance requests.

• Relevant crimes include cybercrime, financial crime, trafficking and organised crime.

• It is a domestic coordination platform, not a new international force.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL CBI acts as India’s National Central Bureau for INTERPOL. A Red Notice is not itself an international arrest warrant; national law governs action.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Common workflows can reduce delays between state agencies and national liaison channels.

• Faster information exchange must retain data-quality checks and safeguards against abusive or erroneous requests.

PRELIMS CAUTION The portal does not replace extradition treaties, INTERPOL or judicial extradition procedure.

MAINS PROMPT Why do transnational crimes require both speed and procedural safeguards?

Sources: [J-BHARATPOL]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

04 · Defence technology

Scramjet: 120-second ground-test milestone

JAN25-032 · P1 · 2025-01-21 (reporting date) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS January reporting highlighted sustained combustion for hypersonic propulsion.

• DRDL demonstrated an actively cooled combustor in a 120-second ground test.

• PIB’s April follow-up explicitly confirms the January milestone.

• The later subscale test exceeded 1,000 seconds; that belongs to April.

• The work supports future hypersonic cruise propulsion.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A scramjet is air-breathing with supersonic combustion; rockets carry oxidiser. Ground endurance, flight validation and fielded capability are separate stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Fuel mixing, stable combustion and thermal management remain difficult technical problems.

• Repeatable tests and domestic materials/fuel capability are important beyond one duration headline.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not turn a combustor ground test into an operational missile flight. The date here is the reporting milestone, not a certified exact test day.

MAINS PROMPT Why must strategic technology reporting distinguish laboratory success from deployed capability?

Sources: [J-SCRAMJET]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

SANJAY Battlefield Surveillance System

JAN25-031 · P1 · 2025-01-24 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The flag-off concerned integrated sensor information for the Army.

• SANJAY integrates ground/aerial inputs into a Common Surveillance Picture.

• Development involved the Army and Bharat Electronics Limited.

• The release states ₹2,402 crore under Buy (Indian).

• Induction was planned in phases from March to October 2025.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Sensor fusion supports situational awareness; it is not identical to autonomous weapon use or a complete targeting decision.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Shared information can improve coordination if communications and data are dependable.

• Interoperability, cyber resilience and performance under electronic interference determine operational value.

PRELIMS CAUTION Flag-off is not proof of completed induction in every formation. The system is not a missile or satellite constellation.

MAINS PROMPT What conditions make networked battlefield information useful rather than overwhelming?

Sources: [J-SANJAY]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

05 · Extractive hazards & governance

Umrangso mine flooding: rat-hole mining

JAN25-063 · P1 · 2025-01-06 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Assam disaster exposed persistent safety and enforcement failures.

• The incident was in Umrangso, Dima Hasao district.

• A later state survey reportedly identified 220 rat-hole mines.

• A judicial inquiry was ordered.

• Rescue/casualty reports changed over time; this note does not claim a final total.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Narrow mine workings, flooding, poor ventilation and inaccessible routes can compound risk. Illegal status does not extinguish worker-safety and rescue obligations.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Closure orders need enforcement, livelihood alternatives and accountability of commercial beneficiaries.

• Mapping, inspection, worker registration and rescue planning should exist before a disaster.

PRELIMS CAUTION This January incident was in Assam, not Meghalaya merely because rat-hole mining is often discussed there.

MAINS PROMPT Why does hazardous illegal mining persist despite bans, and what should prevention involve?

Sources: [J-RATHOLE]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

06 · Mass-gathering safety

Maha Kumbh crowd disaster: governance beyond technology

JAN25-067 · P1 · 2025-01-29 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Prayagraj tragedy brought attention to safety at very large gatherings.

• Authorities reported 30 deaths and at least 60 injuries on 29 January.

• The incident occurred during the Mauni Amavasya rush near the Sangam.

• A three-member judicial inquiry was announced.

• The casualty figure here is the contemporary official report, not an independent final audit.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Mass-gathering risk depends on density, flow, route design and command decisions. A control-room display or surveillance tool cannot by itself ensure safe on-ground capacity.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Cross-read with Tirupati: access points, counterflows and delayed admission controls are recurring administrative concerns.

• Independent inquiry should test planning assumptions, command decisions and rescue access rather than attribute all loss to crowd behaviour.

• Transparent casualty reporting supports both relief and accountability.

PRELIMS CAUTION Official initial totals and independently established final totals need not be identical. Technology deployment is not evidence that the event was safe.

MAINS PROMPT Why must crowd-safety plans combine design capacity, trained personnel and enforceable stop-admission rules?

Sources: [J-KUMBH]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

09 · Coastal policing & coordination

Coastal Security Scheme: shallow-water capacity and agency roles

E5-2501-002 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed implementation gaps. Magazine coverage is an editorial index, not the event date.

- The scheme strengthens coastal-police infrastructure under the MHA framework.
- Patrol craft, trained personnel and stations have complementary roles.
- Coastal police, Coast Guard and Navy have distinct but coordinated responsibilities.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An asset procured is not necessarily an operational patrol capability if staffing, maintenance and communications are missing.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

- AP’s coast requires tested coordination and fishing-community engagement.
- Assess patrol availability and response exercises rather than simply count boats or stations.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat a magazine’s historical coastline figure or proposed phase as a permanently current official inventory.

MAINS PROMPT How can coastal security improve operational coordination beyond infrastructure creation?

Sources: [E5-V2501-28]

Evidence access: Access recorded per source; factual essentials separated from original analytical and exam guidance

International Relations

01 · Neighbourhood diplomacy

India–Afghanistan engagement: contact is not recognition

VM2501-010 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue reviewed the Dubai meeting involving India’s Foreign Secretary and Afghanistan’s acting foreign minister. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The meeting represented high-level engagement with Afghanistan’s de facto authorities.

• Humanitarian assistance, regional security and connectivity are distinct policy dimensions.

• Diplomatic contact does not by itself constitute formal recognition of a government.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Recognition, consular presence, technical engagement and humanitarian cooperation have different legal and political meanings.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Engagement can protect interests while preserving concern for security, inclusive governance and human rights.

• Assess proposed connectivity against implementation capacity and regional constraints, not only strategic narratives.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not infer formal recognition or treaty obligations from a meeting alone.

MAINS PROMPT How can pragmatic engagement with de facto authorities preserve humanitarian and security priorities?

Sources: [V2501-13]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

02 · Global South & multilateralism

Indonesia joins BRICS as a full member

JAN25-038 · P1 · 2025-01-06 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Brazil’s presidency formally announced the accession.

• Brazil’s Foreign Ministry announced full membership on 6 January.

• Candidacy had been endorsed at Johannesburg in 2023; confirmation followed Indonesia’s electoral transition.

• The statement highlighted global-governance reform and Global South cooperation.

• Full membership differs from partner-country status.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL BRICS is a coordination grouping, not a customs union or military alliance. Participation categories carry different implications.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Indonesia broadens the grouping’s Asian and maritime footprint.

• Expansion offers India reform coalitions but increases diversity of interests and coordination difficulty.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call Indonesia merely a partner or memorise a total count without a dated definition of pending/disputed accessions.

MAINS PROMPT What opportunities and limitations accompany expansion of an informal global grouping?

Sources: [J-BRICS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

03 · Indo-Pacific & bilateral relations

India–Indonesia: Republic Day diplomacy

JAN25-039 · P1 · 2025-01-25 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS President Prabowo’s visit connected ceremonial and strategic engagement.

• Prabowo Subianto was chief guest for the 76th Republic Day.

• The talks built on the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership of 2018.

• Areas included critical minerals, energy, space, STEM and disaster management.

• The statement also noted Prambanan conservation and the India–ASEAN tourism year.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Indonesia is an ASEAN member and major maritime state near Indian Ocean–Pacific routes. Cultural ties and strategic cooperation are connected but distinct.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Shared interests include maritime stability, resilient supply chains and disaster response.

• A balanced answer identifies deliverables rather than assuming a military alliance from diplomatic warmth.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not confuse Prabowo with Trinidad and Tobago’s President associated with PBD. The 76th Republic Day marked 75 completed years of the republic.

MAINS PROMPT Why is Indonesia important to India’s Act East and Indo-Pacific approach?

Sources: [J-INDONESIA]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

04 · India–US & technology diplomacy

Three Indian entities removed from US Entity List

JAN25-040 · P1 · 2025-01-15 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS MEA recorded a specific export-control easing after high-level talks.

• Removal was recorded for 15 January 2025.

• The entities were BARC, IGCAR and IREL.

• The list is administered by the US Bureau of Industry and Security.

• This did not itself finalise reactors or remove every civil-nuclear cooperation barrier.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Export controls, liability, safeguards, finance and commercial contracts are distinct layers. Institutional delisting is not a licence for every technology transfer.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The move can support research and energy cooperation.

• Benefits still require workable contracts, supply chains and risk allocation beyond strategic declarations.

PRELIMS CAUTION Delisting is not Indian NSG membership or repeal of Indian liability legislation.

MAINS PROMPT Why can a diplomatic breakthrough take years to become an operational energy project?

Sources: [J-USNUCLEAR]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

US birthright citizenship order: constitutional challenge

JAN25-068 · P1 · 2025-01-20 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The new administration sought to narrow citizenship recognition for some US-born children.

• Executive Order 14160 was issued on 20 January.

• It targeted specified children of mothers unlawfully present or lawfully but temporarily present when the father was neither citizen nor permanent resident.

• Implementation faced a temporary restraining order on 23 January.

• This note records January’s order and injunction, not final merits or later appellate outcomes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Jus soli links citizenship to place of birth; jus sanguinis links it to parentage. The US Fourteenth Amendment and Indian citizenship law have different texts and histories.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The issue illustrates limits on executive power and judicial review of constitutional meaning.

• For Indian families, actual consequences depend on the operative court orders, not only an executive announcement; individual legal advice is outside this study note.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not claim January’s order automatically amended the Constitution or immediately removed citizenship from every existing US-born person.

MAINS PROMPT Compare constitutional limits on executive action with the legislative authority to define citizenship.

Sources: [J-USCIT]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

05 · Climate & health institutions

WHO responds to US intent to withdraw

JAN25-042 · P1 · 2025-01-21 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS WHO warned about consequences for shared health cooperation.

• The statement was issued on 21 January.

• WHO highlighted the US founding relationship since 1948.

• The event was an announced intention, not proof of completed withdrawal that day.

• WHO sought reconsideration and constructive engagement.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL WHO coordinates international health work; it is not a government directly operating every national health system. Funding, surveillance and technical assistance are distinct functions.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Loss of a major contributor can disrupt finance and information-sharing networks.

• Institutional reform should improve accountability while preserving cross-border health functions benefiting all countries.

PRELIMS CAUTION January intent is not evidence for the exact legal membership status in November 2026.

MAINS PROMPT Why is stable global-health financing a collective-security issue?

Sources: [J-WHO]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

US Paris withdrawal: notice and effective date

JAN25-041 · P1 · 2025-01-27 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The UN confirmed formal notification after the US executive announcement.

• The executive decision was announced on 20 January.

• The UN received the withdrawal notification on 27 January.

• The stated effective date under the notice period was 27 January 2026.

• This January action concerned Paris; later separate climate-convention developments need separate verification.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Paris operates under the UN climate convention with nationally determined contributions. An executive announcement and depositary notification are different legal events.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• A major emitter’s reversal can weaken finance, confidence and collective ambition.

• Other parties’ duties continue; India can combine domestic transition, diversified partnerships and advocacy on equity.

PRELIMS CAUTION Withdrawal did not become effective on 20 January 2025. January research does not certify the entire November 2026 treaty position.

MAINS PROMPT How do major-power reversals affect collective-action regimes?

Sources: [J-PARIS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

06 · Neighbourhood & conflict

Indus Waters Treaty: Neutral Expert competence

JAN25-043 · P1 · 2025-01-20 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The legal milestone concerned forum authority, not final project-design merits.

• The Expert examined seven differences involving Kishenganga and Ratle.

• The competence decision was dated 7 January and publicised later that month.

• He concluded the issues fell within his remit and would proceed to merits.

• India welcomed the result while contesting the parallel arbitration process.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Kishenganga is linked to the Jhelum system; Ratle is on the Chenab. Jurisdiction decides whether a forum may hear an issue, not who wins the substantive dispute.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Technical treaty disputes combine engineering evidence with legal interpretation.

• Present India’s position accurately without claiming every design feature was finally vindicated.

PRELIMS CAUTION The World Bank’s appointment role does not mean it decided merits. Later 2025 treaty developments must not be projected backward or ignored in current answers.

MAINS PROMPT Why can forum selection be decisive in a technical river-treaty dispute?

Sources: [J-IWT]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

India–China talks: planned people-centric measures

JAN25-066 · P1 · 2025-01-27 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri’s Beijing visit yielded proposals for gradual functional engagement.

• The two sides agreed to resume Kailash Mansarovar Yatra in summer 2025, with modalities to be discussed.

• They agreed in principle to resume direct air services, requiring technical negotiations.

• An early expert-level meeting on trans-border river cooperation and hydrological data was proposed.

• 2025 marked 75 years of diplomatic relations.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An agreement in principle is not operational implementation. Functional engagement can proceed without resolving all boundary and strategic disputes.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• People-to-people and river-data measures can reduce friction and support risk management.

• A balanced approach distinguishes practical cooperation from unverified claims of complete strategic normalisation.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not say direct flights restarted on 27 January simply because the principle was agreed. This note does not establish a final border settlement.

MAINS PROMPT How can India pursue limited cooperation with a strategically difficult neighbour without obscuring unresolved disputes?

Sources: [J-CHINA]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

07 · Reports & global risk

Global Risks Report 2025: horizons differ

JAN25-045 · P2 · 2025-01-15 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS WEF distinguished immediate, two-year and ten-year perceived risks.

• State-based armed conflict led the immediate 2025 risk question.

• Misinformation/disinformation led the two-year horizon.

• Environmental threats dominated the long term.

• The report reflected perceptions of over 900 cross-sector respondents.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Perceived risk is not a measured death toll, objective probability or official intelligence forecast. Results depend on respondents and horizon.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Interacting geopolitical, information and environmental shocks favour whole-of-government resilience.

• Scenario planning and trusted communication are more useful than memorising a context-free ranking.

PRELIMS CAUTION Always name the time horizon before claiming a number-one risk. This is WEF, not a World Bank or UN index.

MAINS PROMPT How should policymakers use perception-based risk reports without overinterpreting them?

Sources: [J-RISKS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

09 · Foreign-aid ethics & continuity

Foreign-aid disruption: autonomy and responsibility to beneficiaries

E5-2501-001 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue examined the ethical implications of the US aid pause. Magazine coverage is an editorial index, not the event date.

• Aid can finance health, education and humanitarian services.

• Donor strategic interests and beneficiary welfare can diverge.

• A temporary policy pause is distinct from every later institutional decision.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Humanitarian principles, development finance and foreign-policy influence overlap without being identical.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Orderly transition and transparent prioritisation reduce avoidable harm to dependent services.

• Local ownership and diversified funding can reduce vulnerability without assuming all aid is either benevolent or coercive.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not label PEPFAR simply a USAID-owned programme or project later agency changes backward into January.

MAINS PROMPT What ethical duties arise when a donor abruptly changes established aid commitments?

Sources: [E5-V2501-47]

Evidence access: Access recorded per source; factual essentials separated from original analytical and exam guidance

Andhra Pradesh

06 · Green industry & infrastructure

Pudimadaka green-hydrogen hub: foundation

JAN25-046 · P1 · 2025-01-08 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The January project package included a large integrated investment proposal.

• Pudimadaka is near Visakhapatnam in Anakapalli district.

• NTPC Green Energy Limited was the named developer.

• The announced investment envelope was about ₹1.85 lakh crore, including renewable capacity.

• Plans included hydrogen derivatives and exports.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Green hydrogen requires low-emissions electricity and credible certification. Project investment envelope, spending, capacity and actual production are distinct.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP has port and renewable advantages, but competitiveness depends on power cost, utilisation, water planning and buyers.

• Follow the project through finance, approvals, construction and commissioning rather than treating foundation laying as output.

PRELIMS CAUTION January was not inauguration of an operating hydrogen hub. The envelope is not a direct Union-budget cash grant.

MAINS PROMPT Assess AP’s green-hydrogen prospects through resources, markets and environmental safeguards.

Sources: [J-AP], [J-AP2]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Nakkapalli Bulk Drug Park

JAN25-047 · P1 · 2025-01-08 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Foundation laying highlighted common infrastructure for pharmaceutical inputs.

• The project is at Nakkapalli in Anakapalli district.

• The announcement linked the park to healthcare access and industrial development.

• Proximity to the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor/Visakhapatnam–Kakinada region was highlighted.

• Common-infrastructure costs and hoped-for private investment are separate figures.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL APIs/bulk drugs are active ingredients; formulations are final dosage products. Common facilities do not remove individual quality and pollution duties.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Domestic API capacity can improve supply resilience and jobs.

• Effluent treatment, hazardous-waste systems, worker safety and quality assurance are economic essentials, not optional extras.

PRELIMS CAUTION Foundation laying does not establish operating API output. Do not aggregate park cost and investment potential as completed spending.

MAINS PROMPT How can AP develop pharmaceutical clusters without creating industrial-pollution hotspots?

Sources: [J-AP], [J-AP2]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

KRIS City and South Coast Railway HQ

JAN25-048 · P1 · 2025-01-08 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Two separate initiatives addressed industrial nodes and railway administration.

• Krishnapatnam Industrial Area/KRIS City was identified under the Chennai–Bengaluru Industrial Corridor.

• The announcement placed it in Tirupati district.

• The package included foundation laying for South Coast Railway HQ at Visakhapatnam.

• These projects have distinct implementation and financing paths.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An industrial corridor is more than one highway. A railway headquarters building is not identical to every railway-zone infrastructure asset.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Benefits require coordinated land, utilities, freight links and actual firms.

• Planning should connect local suppliers and workers rather than create isolated industrial real estate.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not put KRIS City under the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor simply because both are AP initiatives.

MAINS PROMPT How can industrial corridors become productive ecosystems rather than land-development projects?

Sources: [J-AP], [J-AP2]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

07 · Public enterprises & finances

RINL revival: financial restructuring

JAN25-049 · P1 · 2025-01-17 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS CCEA approved ₹11,440 crore for the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant operator.

• Fresh equity infusion was ₹10,300 crore.

• ₹1,140 crore working-capital loan was converted into 7% non-cumulative preference capital redeemable after ten years.

• RINL was described as a wholly Union-owned CPSE under the Steel Ministry.

• Furnace restoration and production milestones were targets, not certified achievements.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Equity infusion adds capital; loan conversion changes financing structure. Preference capital is not identical to ordinary equity or cash subsidy.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Revival may protect capability and supplier networks, but needs operational reform beyond one infusion.

• Evaluate raw-material security, utilisation, product mix, financing costs and sustained cash generation.

PRELIMS CAUTION Not all ₹11,440 crore was fresh cash equity. Approval does not settle every later ownership-policy or production question.

MAINS PROMPT When is enterprise revival preferable to repeated support without restructuring?

Sources: [J-RINL]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Fiscal Health Index 2025: AP rank 17

JAN25-050 · P1 · 2025-01-24 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS NITI’s inaugural index placed AP near the bottom of the assessed group.

• The index covered 18 major states using FY2022–23 data and longer trends.

• AP scored 20.9 and ranked 17; Punjab ranked 18.

• Odisha led at 67.8, followed by Chhattisgarh and Goa.

• Dimensions: expenditure quality, revenue mobilisation, fiscal prudence, debt index and debt sustainability.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A composite score depends on indicator selection and normalisation. Publication year is not assessment year; a score is not a legal insolvency finding.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP should examine revenues, committed spending, borrowing cost and productive capital expenditure.

• Disaggregate indicators and use later fiscal data to assess change.

• Separate measured results from partisan causal attribution.

PRELIMS CAUTION 20.9 is not an FY2025–26 score. A zero normalised component does not mean literally zero repayments or zero legal borrowing capacity.

MAINS PROMPT Propose fiscally credible AP reforms that protect essential welfare and improve expenditure quality.

Sources: [J-FHI]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

08 · Citizen services

Mana Mitra: WhatsApp governance

JAN25-051 · P1 · 2025-01-30 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS AP launched an interface intended to reduce routine office visits.

• The launch offered 161 services in its first phase.

• Nara Lokesh launched the initiative in collaboration with Meta.

• Examples include payments, revenue/municipal functions, grievances and bookings.

• Expansion plans are future targets, not the verified launch count.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Digital availability, successful application and completed service delivery are different stages. An interface does not replace legal accountability.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Evaluate completion rates, response time, appeals and user satisfaction.

• Telugu access, disability accommodation and assisted/offline alternatives are essential.

• Privacy, phishing/impersonation and dependence on a private platform need safeguards.

PRELIMS CAUTION 161 is launch-stage, not the November 2026 total. An independently unverified world-first slogan is not treated as an exam fact.

MAINS PROMPT Design outcome indicators and privacy protections for conversational citizen services.

Sources: [J-MANA], [J-MANA2]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

09 · Irrigation & disaster resilience

Tirupati crowd disaster: administrative lessons

JAN25-053 · P1 · 2025-01-08 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Six deaths were reported in the rush for darshan tokens.

• The incident occurred on 8 January at token-distribution locations in Tirupati.

• Tokens related to Vaikunta Dwara/Vaikunta Ekadasi arrangements.

• Contemporary reporting recorded six deaths; injury figures varied over time.

• This concerned crowd access management, not collapse of a shrine structure.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Crowd disasters involve density, flow, bottlenecks and pressure. Blaming panic alone can hide design and administrative failures.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Prevention needs timed/distributed access, density limits, separated routes and trained staff.

• Incident command needs stop-admission authority, clear information and medical triage.

• Systemic accountability should not prejudge individual criminal liability.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not vaguely relocate a Tirupati token-centre incident to inside the Tirumala temple. Avoid mixing casualty updates from different times.

MAINS PROMPT As district collector, design a safety plan for a major religious gathering.

Sources: [J-TIRUPATI]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Polavaram: new diaphragm-wall work

JAN25-052 · P1 · 2025-01-18 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The replacement-wall construction milestone was reported in January.

• Work began on 18 January according to the report.

• The stated estimate was ₹990 crore for about 1,400 metres.

• The project is on the Godavari.

• Panel-wise execution and central technical scrutiny were described.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A diaphragm wall is a deep foundation cutoff controlling seepage. It differs from spillway, cofferdam and the full earth-cum-rockfill dam.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• River works need flood-aware sequencing, geotechnical evidence and independent quality checks.

• APPSC analysis should cover benefits alongside rehabilitation, safety, environmental and interstate obligations.

PRELIMS CAUTION Beginning a wall does not mean Polavaram was completed. A political target is not a completion certificate.

MAINS PROMPT What institutional safeguards improve complex multipurpose river projects?

Sources: [J-POLAVARAM]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

NDRF Raising Day and NIDM capacity

JAN25-054 · P1 · 2025-01-19 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Vijayawada hosted the 20th Raising Day and associated infrastructure initiatives.

• The event was on 19 January.

• PIB described about ₹220 crore of inauguration/foundation initiatives.

• Facilities included NIDM’s southern campus, NDRF’s 10th Battalion infrastructure and Supaul’s regional response centre.

• Supaul is not in AP merely because its initiative featured at Vijayawada.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL NDRF specialises in response; NIDM focuses on training, research and capacity. Prevention also requires local planning and community capability.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP’s coastal exposure makes training, pre-positioning and drills valuable.

• Judge investment through response readiness and coordination rather than ceremony expenditure.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not conflate NIDM with NDRF or locate every named facility in Vijayawada.

MAINS PROMPT How should national specialist response support stronger district preparedness?

Sources: [J-NDRF]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

10 · Biodiversity, crafts & culture

Flamingo Festival: Pulicat–Nelapattu landscape

JAN25-055 · P1 · 2025-01-18 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Tirupati district scheduled the event for 18–20 January.

• Named venues included Nelapattu, Atakanithippa, Sullurupeta, B.V. Palem and Sri City.

• The festival ran across a wider bird-habitat landscape.

• Pulicat and Nelapattu are distinct ecological locations.

• Use current district geography rather than uncritically copying older district labels.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Pulicat is a brackish lagoon spanning the AP–Tamil Nadu coastal region; Nelapattu is a distinct bird sanctuary. A festival is not a Ramsar designation.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Nature tourism can support local income and conservation if disturbance, waste and habitat pressure are controlled.

• Protect water regimes and compatible livelihoods beyond festival days.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat Pulicat and Nelapattu as one water body or every venue as a Ramsar site.

MAINS PROMPT How can bird-tourism festivals support conservation rather than damage the resource?

Sources: [J-FLAMINGO]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Etikoppaka tableau: third jury prize

JAN25-056 · P2 · 2025-01-29 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS AP’s Republic Day presentation received jury recognition.

• The theme showcased traditional Etikoppaka wooden toys.

• The result was announced on 29 January after the 26 January parade.

• Reporting highlighted Telugu craft/cultural motifs.

• The third prize was a jury-category award.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Living craft heritage includes skills, materials and markets. Etikoppaka is associated with lacquered wooden toys.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Recognition can help only if followed by fair procurement, design support and durable market links.

• Sustainable materials and authentic attribution can preserve skills while allowing innovation.

PRELIMS CAUTION A tableau award is not a new GI registration. Jury results and popular-vote categories are different.

MAINS PROMPT What should AP craft policy do beyond publicity to sustain artisan livelihoods?

Sources: [J-TOYS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Culture & History

01 · Archaeology & scientific evidence

Tamil Nadu iron chronology: evaluate the dating context

VM2501-008 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-01 · web posted: 2025-02-22 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed Antiquity of Iron and new radiometric-date claims. This is a 2025-01 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The report concerns archaeological sites in Tamil Nadu, including Sivagalai and Mayiladumparai.

• Methods discussed include radiocarbon dating and optically stimulated luminescence.

• Claims of very early iron technology depend on the association between dated samples, stratigraphy and metallurgical evidence.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Radiocarbon ordinarily dates associated organic material, not the age of an iron object directly; sediment dating addresses another evidentiary question.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• New dates can revise chronologies when context and independent analyses are robust.

• Distinguish a reported claim from a universally established world-first conclusion and make uncertainty intelligible to readers.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not present every proposed date as direct dating of iron or collapse publication, sample context and technological onset into one date.

MAINS PROMPT Why must archaeological chronologies be assessed through context as well as laboratory dates?

Sources: [V2501-45]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

01 · Diaspora & historical memory

18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas

JAN25-057 · P2 · 2025-01-09 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The 8–10 January convention connected diaspora engagement and development.

• The venue was Bhubaneswar, Odisha.

• The theme was Diaspora’s Contribution to a Viksit Bharat.

• The PM inaugurated on 9 January; the President presented awards on 10 January.

• Christine Carla Kangaloo of Trinidad and Tobago was chief guest.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL 9 January recalls Gandhi’s return from South Africa in 1915. OCI status is not Indian citizenship and does not automatically confer voting rights.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Engagement includes knowledge networks, investment, culture and crisis assistance—not just remittances.

• AP should connect investment outreach with ethical recruitment and protection of vulnerable migrant workers.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not confuse the PBD chief guest with the Indonesian President attending Republic Day.

MAINS PROMPT How can diaspora policy balance economic engagement and migrant protection?

Sources: [J-PBD]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Awards & Sports

01 · National honours

Padma Awards 2025: exact categories

JAN25-058 · P3 · 2025-01-25 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The list contained 139 awards, including a duo counted as one.

• Seven Padma Vibhushan, 19 Padma Bhushan and 113 Padma Shri were approved.

• Vibhushan names: D. Nageshwar Reddy, J.S. Khehar, Kumudini Lakhia, L. Subramaniam, M.T. Vasudevan Nair, Osamu Suzuki and Sharda Sinha.

• The final three in that list were posthumous.

• Announcement and investiture are separate events.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Award category, field, state/country attribution and posthumous status should be revised separately. Civilian honours do not confer hereditary privilege.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Use the official full list for AP-linked names; Telugu association does not automatically mean official AP attribution.

• Prioritise accurate matching and representative contributions rather than replacing policy study with name lists.

PRELIMS CAUTION 139 awards need not mean 139 separate individuals because a duo counts once. D. Nageshwar Reddy is listed under Telangana.

MAINS PROMPT How are civilian awards distinguished from constitutionally prohibited titles?

Sources: [J-PADMA]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

02 · Sports awards

National Sports Awards 2024 announced

JAN25-059 · P3 · 2025-01-02 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The edition year differs from its January 2025 announcement.

• Khel Ratna recipients: Gukesh D. (chess), Harmanpreet Singh (hockey), Praveen Kumar (para-athletics), Manu Bhaker (shooting).

• Jyothi Yarraji was among Arjuna awardees.

• Arjuna Lifetime recipients were Sucha Singh and Murlikant Rajaram Petkar.

• Announcement: 2 January; presentation scheduled for 17 January.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Khel Ratna, Arjuna and Dronacharya have distinct purposes; Dronacharya recognises coaches.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Para-sport recognition supports discussion of inclusive infrastructure and athlete pathways.

• For APPSC, revise discipline–award matching without letting celebrity recall displace high-priority analysis.

PRELIMS CAUTION Gukesh did not receive the Dronacharya Award in this list. The 2024 edition was not announced in January 2024.

MAINS PROMPT What measures would improve inclusive sports participation for persons with disabilities?

Sources: [J-AWARDS]

Evidence access: Full substantive PIB text read

03 · Competitions

Australian Open 2025: singles champions

JAN25-061 · P3 · 2025-01-26 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The January Grand Slam concluded in Melbourne.

• Jannik Sinner beat Alexander Zverev in men’s singles.

• Madison Keys beat Aryna Sabalenka in women’s singles.

• Sinner defended his title; Keys won her first Grand Slam singles title.

• Sinner represents Italy and Keys the United States.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Revise winner, runner-up, nationality and edition separately. Melbourne is the tournament location.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• This is lower-priority factual PSC revision rather than a core analytical theme.

• Use short spaced-recall drills so results do not consume disproportionate study time.

PRELIMS CAUTION Sabalenka entered as defending champion but did not win the 2025 final.

MAINS PROMPT Recall both winner–runner-up pairs without looking.

Sources: [J-AO]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

38th National Games: Green Games

JAN25-060 · P3 · 2025-01-28 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Games opened in Dehradun and continued into February.

• Inauguration was on 28 January.

• Host state: Uttarakhand.

• Theme: Green Games.

• The official account highlighted environmental measures and indigenous sports.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Opening date, host, disciplines and final medal table are separate fields. Environmental claims need lifecycle evaluation.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• A credible legacy includes community use and maintenance, not only venue construction.

• Assess travel, energy, materials and waste rather than accepting green branding alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not put February’s final medal table into an as-of-31-January account. Announced green measures are not an independent audit.

MAINS PROMPT What would a credible environmental and social legacy plan include?

Sources: [J-GAMES]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

January 2025 recall laboratory

30 original questions, not previous-year questions. Answers follow all questions. Historical monthly snapshot only.

1. Which best describes the January 2025 DPDP Rules development?

A. Final rules commenced universally

B. Draft rules were opened for consultation

C. The DPDP Act was repealed

D. Data protection was transferred to RBI

2. Which provision concerns the President’s special address at the first session of each year?

A. Article 87

B. Article 108

C. Article 110

D. Article 280

3. The January PG medical-admissions decision principally concerned:

A. All reservation in undergraduate education

B. Abolition of NEET

C. Residence reservation in PG medical courses

D. A ban on institutional preference of any kind

4. Which is an accurate January UCC statement?

A. A nationwide code commenced

B. Article 44 became a Fundamental Right

C. Goa never had a distinct civil framework

D. Uttarakhand commenced its code on 27 January

5. The January ₹69,515.71 crore crop-insurance figure referred to:

A. Total outlay for FY2021–22 to FY2025–26

B. A single-year farmer cash transfer

C. Only the technology fund

D. The annual AP state budget

6. Which pair is correctly matched?

A. WINDS—judicial appointments

B. YES-TECH—technology-based yield estimation

C. RWBCIS—direct field-loss measurement in every case

D. FIAT—space launch vehicle

7. The National Turmeric Board inauguration venue and designated headquarters were respectively:

A. Nizamabad and New Delhi

B. Hyderabad and Vijayawada

C. New Delhi and Nizamabad

D. Visakhapatnam and Guntur

8. ASER 2024 is best described as:

A. A census of every urban university

B. RBI banking survey

C. A government-only administrative school register

D. A non-government rural household learning survey

9. Why must ASER percentages be qualified by school category?

A. Government-school-only and all-school figures can differ

B. All surveys use identical denominators

C. Only urban pupils are surveyed

D. The report has no reading assessments

10. What did the January GDP first advance estimate report for real FY2024–25 growth?

A. 8.2% as a never-revisable result

B. 6.4%, subject to later revision

C. 6.4% nominal inflation

D. A contraction of 6.4%

11. The Survey’s real FY2025–26 growth forecast range was:

A. 2.0–3.0%

B. 10.0–12.0%

C. 6.3–6.8%

D. A guaranteed 8.0%

12. The January Eighth Pay Commission approval established:

A. A final fitment factor

B. An immediate doubling of all state salaries

C. Automatic implementation of all recommendations

D. Approval to constitute the commission

13. Under LEADS 2024, AP was a coastal:

A. Fast Mover

B. Achiever

C. UN-designated logistics capital

D. Precisely ranked number one nationally

14. Which best describes the MSME guarantee announced in January?

A. An unconditional ₹100 crore grant per firm

B. 60% guarantee cover for eligible machinery loans up to ₹100 crore

C. A guarantee of every MSME profit

D. A tax exemption for all factories

15. Which pairing is correct?

A. Surat—P17A frigate

B. Nilgiri—P75 submarine

C. Vaghsheer—P75 submarine

D. Vaghsheer—nuclear ballistic-missile submarine

16. The 120-second scramjet milestone demonstrated:

A. An operational missile combat deployment

B. A human spaceflight

C. A 1,000-second January flight

D. A combustor ground test

17. What did the NVS-02 mission establish?

A. Successful launcher injection, followed by an orbit-raising problem

B. A completely failed launcher with no orbit insertion

C. Proof of final operational navigation service

D. ISRO’s 100th satellite

18. The Third Launch Pad January decision was:

A. A completed operational pad

B. Approval with a stated 48-month establishment target

C. A change of Sriharikota to Tamil Nadu

D. A new satellite rather than infrastructure

19. Which comparison is valid?

A. Every annual anomaly proves permanent Paris failure

B. All climate baselines are interchangeable

C. One calendar-year exceedance differs from long-term Paris threshold assessment

D. The 2024 anomaly was an Indian-only statistic

20. Which is correctly matched among the January-end Ramsar additions?

A. Udhwa—Sikkim

B. Khecheopalri—Tamil Nadu

C. Therthangal—Jharkhand

D. Sakkarakottai—Tamil Nadu

21. BRICS full membership announced on 6 January concerned:

A. Indonesia

B. Every African Union country

C. All ASEAN members together

D. The European Union

22. The Indus Neutral Expert’s January decision principally established:

A. A final award approving all design details

B. Competence to examine the specified differences

C. Termination of the treaty in January

D. World Bank adjudication on merits

23. What is the best interpretation of WEF’s 78 million net jobs figure?

A. Jobs already created in AP

B. A government recruitment guarantee

C. A global projection through 2030 from created minus displaced roles

D. Only jobs in artificial intelligence

24. What was the RINL package composition?

A. ₹11,440 crore entirely fresh cash equity

B. Only a private-company takeover

C. A guarantee of achieved production targets

D. ₹10,300 crore equity plus ₹1,140 crore loan conversion

25. The Fiscal Health Index 2025 AP result related primarily to:

A. FY2022–23 data; score 20.9 and rank 17 of 18

B. November 2026 accounts

C. A rank of 17 among every country

D. A score of 67.8 for AP

26. Mana Mitra’s first-phase launch count was:

A. 1,610 completed industrial projects

B. 161 services

C. 161 crore users

D. A guaranteed current service total for all future dates

27. KRIS City at Krishnapatnam was identified under:

A. Delhi–Mumbai corridor

B. Amritsar–Kolkata corridor

C. Chennai–Bengaluru corridor

D. Every AP corridor interchangeably

28. A diaphragm wall at Polavaram principally serves as:

A. The final reservoir itself

B. A turbine-generator

C. An administrative district boundary

D. A foundation seepage-cutoff structure

29. Which distinction is correct?

A. NDRF—response; NIDM—training/research/capacity

B. NIDM and NDRF are the same battalion

C. Every facility mentioned at Vijayawada is in AP

D. Training alone replaces evacuation planning

30. Which is the soundest general rule for this archive?

A. Treat all announcements as implementation

B. Always separate proposal, approval, notification, commencement and actual outcome

C. Use report year as data year

D. Use launch success as proof of every mission phase

Explained answer key

1. B The January version was a draft consultation. Proposal, final notification and commencement must be distinguished. [JAN25-002]

2. A Article 87 governs the special address. Article 108 concerns a joint sitting for legislative deadlock. [JAN25-001]

3. C The holding concerned residence-based reservation in PG courses. Reasonable institutional preference was distinguished. [JAN25-005]

4. D Uttarakhand's commencement was state-specific; Article 44 remains a Directive Principle. [JAN25-004]

5. A The total covered the five-year period. FIAT was separately stated as ₹824.77 crore. [JAN25-019]

6. B YES-TECH concerns yield-estimation technology. WINDS concerns weather information. Weather-index insurance can exhibit basis risk. [JAN25-019]

7. C The inauguration was in New Delhi; the headquarters was designated in Nizamabad, Telangana. [JAN25-021]

8. D ASER is associated with Pratham and uses household-based rural evidence. UDISE+ is a different administrative system. [JAN25-022]

9. A For example, 23.4% government-school Standard III reading is not interchangeable with the all-school percentage. [JAN25-022]

10. B 6.4% was the January first advance estimate. It is a historical vintage, not a certified latest figure. [JAN25-009]

11. C The Survey projected 6.3–6.8%; a forecast range is not a realised outcome. [JAN25-010]

12. D Final recommendations and government implementation are separate stages. [JAN25-012]

13. A AP and Goa were coastal Fast Movers. LEADS categories are not identical to a national numerical ranking. [JAN25-017]

14. B A guarantee shares specified lender risk. The borrower still owes the loan and needs lender approval. [JAN25-015]

15. C Surat is P15B; Nilgiri is P17A; Vaghsheer is a conventional Scorpene-class P75 submarine. [JAN25-030]

16. D Ground testing is different from flight validation and fielded capability. The over-1,000-second follow-up was later. [JAN25-032]

17. A The GSLV-F15 launch succeeded, while ISRO later reported a spacecraft orbit-raising valve issue. [JAN25-027]

18. B Approval was the milestone; construction and readiness require later verification. [JAN25-026]

19. C WMO's 1.55°C headline was a global annual estimate relative to pre-industrial conditions. [JAN25-034]

20. D Khecheopalri is in Sikkim; Udhwa is in Jharkhand; the two TN additions were Sakkarakottai and Therthangal. [JAN25-035]

21. A Brazil's presidency announced Indonesia as a full member, not simply a partner. [JAN25-038]

22. B Competence is jurisdiction; merits were to follow. The Bank's appointment role is different from deciding the dispute. [JAN25-043]

23. C The projected 170 million created minus 92 million displaced yields 78 million globally. Distribution remains uneven. [JAN25-044]

24. D The conversion was into specified preference capital; financial structure and actual operations must be separated. [JAN25-049]

25. A Publication year was 2025; assessment data were earlier. Odisha, not AP, scored 67.8. [JAN25-050]

26. B The 30 January launch offered 161 services. Later expansion requires fresh evidence. [JAN25-051]

27. C The project announcement places KRIS City under the Chennai–Bengaluru Industrial Corridor. [JAN25-048]

28. D It is a deep cutoff structure, distinct from the spillway, cofferdam and full dam. [JAN25-052]

29. A Their mandates differ. Supaul’s response centre does not become an AP facility because of the event venue. [JAN25-054]

30. B Stage, date, denominator and source-access distinctions prevent many common current-affairs errors. [JAN25-006]

Mains answer laboratory

Original answer-building guidance, not model predictions or official marking schemes. Use the historical January evidence only for the proposition it supports. Suggested answer length: 150–250 words. Do not copy these outlines mechanically.

1. Digital convenience does not automatically mean good governance

Use: DPDP draft rules, Aadhaar authentication changes, Entity Locker and Mana Mitra.

Opening: Digital interfaces can reduce transaction costs, but success means a completed lawful service—not just an application or app download.

Argument: Reusable documents and conversational services reduce repeated visits. Purpose-limited verification can simplify access. Yet inaccessible design, failed authentication, weak consent and uncorrectable errors can shift administrative burdens onto the citizen.

Safeguards: Assisted and offline routes; understandable Telugu/English notices; minimal data collection; auditable sharing; time-bound appeals; disability accommodation; clear responsibility when a private platform fails.

Evidence: Mana Mitra launched with 161 services on 30 January. That is a service-availability count, not proof that every application succeeded. January DPDP rules were only a draft.

Conclusion: Evaluate digital government by completion time, inclusion, remedy and trust, not interface novelty alone.

2. AP industrial strategy: from announcements to productive ecosystems

Use: Pudimadaka, Nakkapalli, KRIS City, LEADS and MSME credit guarantees.

Opening: A coastline and large investment proposals are assets, but industrial competitiveness comes from coordinated systems.

Opportunity: Ports, renewables, pharmaceutical capability and corridor nodes can support tradable production. Machinery finance can enable local suppliers to upgrade.

Conditions: Reliable utilities; competitive logistics; clear approvals; skill pathways; verified demand; robust effluent treatment; water planning; and transparent implementation milestones.

Evidence: AP was a coastal Fast Mover in LEADS 2024. January foundation stones indicate project initiation, not producing capacity. The ₹1.85 lakh crore hydrogen envelope is not money already spent.

Evaluation: Track realised investment, commissioning, local supplier contracts, decent jobs, exports and environmental compliance. Distinguish output from promises.

Conclusion: Move from event-led investment promotion to measurable ecosystem delivery.

3. AP fiscal consolidation without indiscriminate welfare cuts

Use: NITI Fiscal Health Index and RINL restructuring.

Opening: Fiscal health is the ability to fund public priorities sustainably, not simply a low headline deficit.

Diagnosis: The 2025 index assessed earlier data: AP scored 20.9 and ranked 17 among 18 states using FY2022–23 evidence. Disaggregate expenditure quality, own-revenue capacity, borrowing costs and debt sustainability before prescribing a remedy.

Reforms: Improve tax administration and compliance; review poorly targeted concessions; protect basic health, learning and nutrition; evaluate schemes by outcomes; prioritise high-return maintenance and capital works; disclose guarantees and contingent liabilities.

Caution: Do not treat a composite score as a finding of insolvency. Do not add Union CPSE support mechanically to AP's state budget: RINL's package concerns a Union-owned enterprise.

Conclusion: Credible consolidation combines transparency, revenue effort and expenditure quality with protection of vulnerable households.

4. Mass-gathering safety is a governance responsibility

Use: Tirupati, Maha Kumbh and NIDM/NDRF.

Opening: A crowd becomes dangerous when inflow exceeds safe capacity and escape or communication fails. "Panic" is not an adequate explanation of a systems failure.

Before: Risk assessment, venue capacity, route separation, timed access, distributed token allocation, accessible exits, staff training, medical planning and public information.

During: A single incident-command structure; real-time density information; authority to stop admission; rapid communication with transport operators; protected ambulance access; and triage.

After: Transparent reporting, relief, independent inquiry and time-bound corrective action. Avoid prejudging liability before evidence is examined.

Institutional link: NIDM contributes training and capacity; NDRF contributes specialist response. Neither replaces local planning.

Conclusion: Technology helps only when coupled with safe design, trained personnel and enforceable operating rules.

5. Scientific self-reliance requires capability chains

Use: SpaDeX, the Third Launch Pad, NVS-02, scramjet testing and critical minerals.

Opening: Strategic autonomy depends on a chain of capabilities from materials and design to testing, production, operations and maintenance.

Evidence: SpaDeX demonstrated docking. The Third Launch Pad was approved. GSLV-F15 achieved transfer-orbit injection, but NVS-02 later had an orbit-raising problem. January's scramjet milestone was a ground test.

Analysis: Each milestone reduces a distinct constraint; none proves completion of every downstream mission. Domestic component ecosystems and repeatable qualification matter as much as headline demonstrations.

Policy: Stable research support; transparent stage-gates; supplier development; robust failure analysis; test infrastructure; skills; and environmental safeguards in upstream resource supply.

Conclusion: Celebrate progress accurately while distinguishing approval, prototype, validation and deployable capability.

6. Climate resilience is local, even when climate evidence is global

Use: WMO assessment, Mission Mausam and wetlands.

Opening: WMO's 2024 annual anomaly of about 1.55°C above the pre-industrial baseline signals urgency, but it is not identical to a long-term Paris threshold determination.

Local risks: AP faces interacting cyclone, flood, heat, livelihood and coastal pressures. Hazard information must reach exposed people in time and in usable form.

Policy mix: Better observations and warnings; evacuation planning; heat-health action; resilient water/power services; wetland and catchment protection; land-use enforcement; and livelihood-sensitive adaptation.

Evidence caution: Ramsar recognition does not guarantee ecological recovery, and radar procurement does not prove warning uptake.

Evaluation: Lead time, last-mile reach, ecosystem condition, vulnerable-population coverage and avoided loss.

Conclusion: Mitigation shapes future risk, while adaptation reduces present vulnerability; neither substitutes for the other.

7. Foundational learning needs evidence, not only access targets

Use: ASER 2024 and the Survey's development priorities.

Opening: Enrolment is necessary but cannot establish that children acquire foundational reading and numeracy.

Evidence: Government-school Standard III reading of Standard II text improved to 23.4% in rural ASER 2024, from 16.3% in 2022. Recovery is real but the absolute shortfall remains large.

Policy: Diagnose actual learning level; provide structured support; use low-stakes formative assessment; support teachers; engage families; and ensure language-appropriate materials. Avoid punitive use of a single test.

Method: ASER household evidence and UDISE+ administrative records answer different questions. For AP, use the state tables rather than assuming the national pattern establishes an exact state rank.

Conclusion: Judge education spending by equitable learning progress as well as buildings, devices and enrolment.

8. Expanding international cooperation without overstating convergence

Use: Indonesia's BRICS membership, India–Indonesia talks and India–China functional measures.

Opening: India's diplomacy must build useful coalitions while recognising differences among partners.

Opportunities: BRICS expansion can support global-governance reform; Indonesia adds major maritime and economic weight. Bilateral cooperation can support supply chains, culture and disaster response. Limited India–China functional engagement can reduce friction even with unresolved strategic disputes.

Limits: A grouping is not a military alliance. A visit is not proof that every agreement is implemented. January agreement in principle on direct flights required technical follow-up.

Approach: Issue-specific cooperation, transparent deliverables, diversified partnerships and careful management of sovereignty/security interests.

Conclusion: Strategic autonomy is strengthened by practical capability and options, not by describing every diplomatic contact as either full alignment or total failure.

Source register

Evidence access is recorded explicitly. Most non-PRS references were inspected as source extracts; primary full-text review remains open for them.

[ENV] PIB · Environment year-end review 2025

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleaseDetail.aspx?PRID=2210100&reg=3&lang=1

Source check recorded in first edition; full-text access provenance not retained

[PRI] PIB · Panchayati Raj review 2025

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2209532&reg=3&lang=2

Source check recorded in first edition; full-text access provenance not retained

[NCMM] PIB · Cabinet approval, 29 January 2025

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleseDetailm.aspx?PRID=2097309&reg=3&lang=2

Source check recorded in first edition; full-text access provenance not retained

[SPACE] ISRO · SpaDeX undocking

https://www.isro.gov.in/spadex_undocking_successful.html

Source check recorded in first edition; full-text access provenance not retained

[J-PRS] PRS · January 2025 Monthly Policy Review; complete report read

https://prsindia.org/policy/monthly-policy-review/january-2025

Full substantive text read

[J-SC] Supreme Court · PG medical admissions judgment, 29 January; reference through PRS

https://api.sci.gov.in/supremecourt/2019/15961/15961_2019_4_1502_59041_Judgement_29-Jan-2025.pdf

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

[J-MSME] PIB · MSME guarantee, 29 January; reference through PRS

https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2097455

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

[J-LCO] PIB · Cable Rules amendment, 17 January; reference through PRS

https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseIframePage.aspx?PRID=2093753

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

[J-DIA] PIB · Diamond Imprest Authorisation, 21 January; reference through PRS

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2094862

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

[J-IST] PIB · Draft IST rules, 27 January; reference through PRS

https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2096622

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

[J-AP] PIB · AP project visit preview, 6 January

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2090664

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

[J-AP2] PTI / Moneycontrol · AP foundation events, 8 January

https://www.moneycontrol.com/news/india/pm-modi-inaugurates-projects-worth-over-rs-2-lakh-crore-in-andhra-pradesh-s-visakhapatnam-12906079.html

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

[J-RINL] PIB · RINL revival, 17 January

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2093843

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

[J-MANA] The News Minute · Mana Mitra, 30 January

https://www.thenewsminute.com/andhra-pradesh/andhra-govt-launches-whatsapp-governance-with-161-citizen-services

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

[J-MANA2] The New Indian Express · Mana Mitra, 31 January

https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/andhra-pradesh/2025/Jan/31/accessing-govt-services-with-mana-mitra-will-be-as-easy-as-texting-a-friend-lokesh

Search-result source extract inspected; full page/document review pending

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Unfinished research

Not exhaustive. Expanded monthly volumes are selected research batches; the rest of the requested archive remains incomplete. No month has passed a complete daily source audit. Full-text and source-extract evidence are distinguished. Historical notes do not certify current law, implementation or latest statistics.

Daily-source reconciliation remains open for every month. Further periods remain unfinished. The monthly inventory and daily/monthly ledgers record work required, not additional completed coverage.

The automation files collect links only after deployment and enabling. No hidden researcher will fill the remaining months after this response.

Read research/Research-Status.md for corrections, exclusions, evidence caveats and close-out tasks.